

If nothing's going to stop you, and you want to write native games, details of some of what you'll need are at <http://blog.mecheye.net/2012/06/the-linux-graphics-stack/>.

One additional word needs to be said about 3D acceleration – most modern games use your 3D card to give great graphical effects, and if you want to be a guru, you'll probably need to learn this sometime. Fedora 20 worked with my almost five year-old card out-of-the-box, which would be great for those aforementioned mentioned native games, but in JavaScript, you'll have to use something called 'WebGL', which is a version of the 3D API OpenGL specifically made for the Web. An API makes your life easier by making the card do a lot of the hard work for you, and has all the facilities to make those games look good. Personally, I've pledged that I'm NOT going to use 3D cards until I've absolutely mastered what can be done without one. There is a HUGE market for folks who don't have one, and would still like to play a game that looks good. And that's simply not the Linux/hacker spirit – Quake was done without one (well, obviously, since it was the game that created the market for them, as I mentioned earlier), so..... until I write something like Quake, no WebGL for me! As an example of what can be achieved without any 3D hardware, check out Matt Westcott's 'Fake Plastic Cubes' and 'Fake Plastic Cubes 2' demos at matt.west.co.tt.

If you find all this JavaScript stuff too intimidating, don't worry. An easy way to get started with game programming is

the language 'Processing' available at www.processing.org. This is much simpler, and really, tremendously good FUN! There are whole books you can buy that teach you how to use it, which are mentioned on the site, so take a look. If you're worried about installing it, it ships out-of-the-box with the distro PureDyne, available at <http://puredyne.en.malavida.com/linux/>. Unfortunately, it looks like this distro's Web page has gone down, but if you guys want it on one of OSFY's cover discs, how about mailing the editor and letting him know? One final thing that I'm just going to touch on here for the sake of completeness is about using a game engine—Unreal Engine is available for Linux, and it recently went free for students and for academic use (<https://www.unrealengine.com/blog/unreal-engine-4-and-linux>). So if you feel like that's your thing, be sure to check it out! Let me know how it went! **END** 

References

- [1] http://www.gog.com/news/gogcom_now_supports_linux
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- [7] <https://www.unrealengine.com/blog/unreal-engine-4-and-linux>

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